



Authentication Methods Policy Alignment

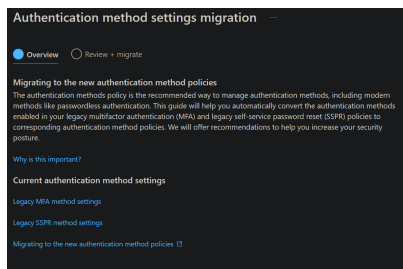
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There are two authentication methods policies, one is related to Self Service Password Reset, and the other is what can be used for MFA for primary authentication.

On September 30th, 2025, the legacy multifactor authentication and self-service password reset policies will be deprecated and you'll manage all authentication methods here in the [authentication methods policy](#).

As we audit existing policies, we must migrate clients to the [centralized policy](#). Here are the steps to perform this alignment task

[Microsoft recommends users move away from using text messages or voice calls for multifactor authentication. Modern authentication methods like Microsoft Authenticator are a recommended alternative.](#)

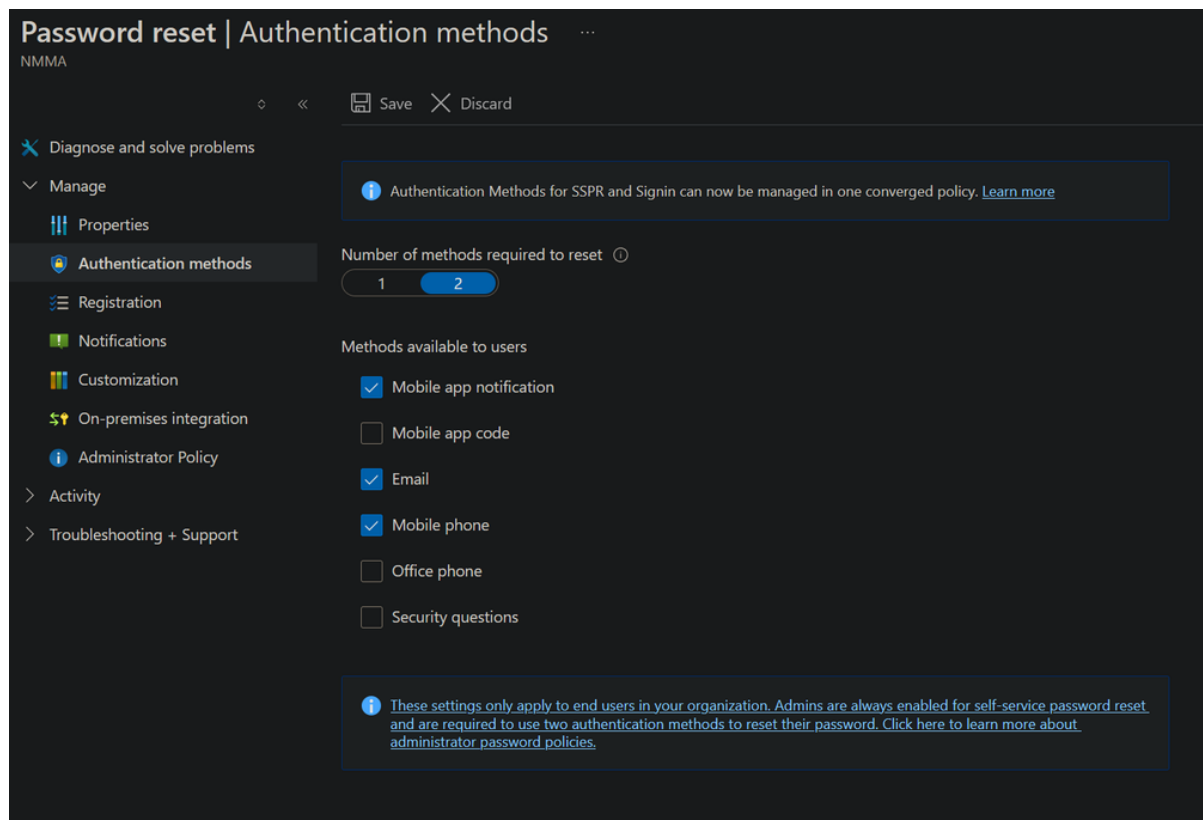


1 Review Current State



Review existing SSPR Authentication Methods

- [Auth Methods Settings Migration](#)



Review Legacy MFA method settings

- [Auth Methods Settings Migration](#)

- The purpose of reviewing these results is to identify if a majority of users have a default MFA method that is less secure, such as SMS, Voice, and Email as the default.
- It can give insight to determine what the impact of a policy change will be, before making it.
- Additionally, this will help us and the client understand if internal communication is needed before making the change, to reduce support requests. Users can update their MFA by visiting aka.ms/mfasetup
- If the results indicate that everyone is already using a secure method by default, the change is transparent to end users and can be made anytime (best case scenario)

3 Client Communication

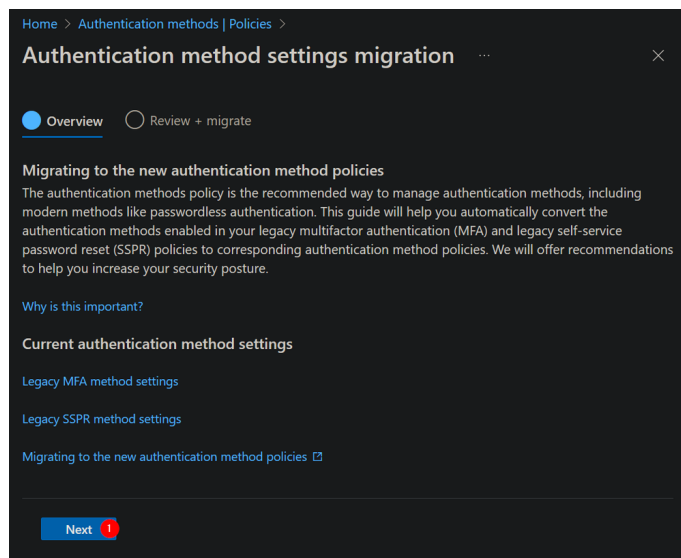


- Discuss the current state with the POC and recommend no longer allowing the less secure methods. After assessing the impact of this change and internal communication is issued (if needed), confirm with the client when this change will take place and schedule accordingly
- Additionally, you can target specific groups for each method, to limit insecure methods to only users who are an exception I.E. a user that doesn't have a smartphone would need SMS or a hardware token.

4 Complete migration to the centralized policy



- Confirm with the client when this change will take place and schedule accordingly
- Click **Next** to begin configuring the central policy



- Microsoft will show their recommendations by default, disable all low security methods by setting each one to 'Off'. Hardware tokens are optional, turn this on if the client is using them, but if not, keep it off.

Authentication method settings migration

Overview

Review + migrate

Authentication method policies

If a method is enabled in either legacy MFA or SSPR policy, it'll be enabled in the authentication methods policy. If a user is in scope for a method, they may use it to authenticate and for password reset (some methods aren't supported for some scenarios). [Learn more](#)

As part of migrating your authentication methods, we recommend enabling passkeys and temporary access pass for users to leverage the most seamless and secure methods for authentication and recovery. See [passkey settings](#) for the latest on which passkeys are enabled by default.

Method	Status	Targeted users & groups	Security
Passkey (FIDO2) RECOMMENDED	On	All users	High security
Temporary access pass RECOMMENDED	On	All users	High security
Microsoft Authenticator (push & passwordless) RECOMMENDED	On	All users	High security
Hardware OATH tokens	Off		Medium security
Third-party software OATH tokens	On	All users	Medium security
Email OTP	Off		Low security
SMS	Off		Low security
Voice call	Off		Low security

Previous

Migrate

- Additionally, you can target specific groups for each method, to limit insecure methods to only users who are an exception I.E. a user that doesn't have a smartphone would need SMS or a hardware token.
- Third party software OATH tokens should be targeted to a group that contain's XL admin account(s) as we store MFA codes in Keeper and don't use Microsoft Authenticator, not doing this can potentially lock you out!